

PagerDuty

Incident Response > **Home**

This documentation covers parts of the PagerDuty Incident Response process. It is a cut-down version of our internal documentation used at PagerDuty for any major incidents and to prepare new employees for on-call responsibilities. It provides information not only on preparing for an incident, but also what to do during and after the incident. It is intended to be used by on-call practitioners and those involved in an operational incident response process (or those wishing to enact a formal incident response process). See the [about page \[about/\]](#) for more information on what this documentation is and why it exists.

Don't know where to start?

If you're new to incident response and don't yet have a formal process in your organization, we recommend looking at our [Getting Started \[getting_started/\]](#) page for a quick list of things you can do to begin. Additionally, you can check out our [Training Course \[training/courses/incident_response/\]](#) page for a more detailed overview of our process.

Being On-Call

If you've never been on-call before, you might be wondering what it's all about. These pages describe what the expectations of being on-call are, along with some resources to help you.

- > [Being On-Call \[oncall/being_oncall/\]](#) - *A guide to being on-call, both what your responsibilities are, and what they are not.*
- > [Alerting Principles \[oncall/alerting_principles/\]](#) - *The principles we use to determine what things page an engineer, and what time of day they page.*

Before an Incident

Reading material for things you probably want to know before an incident occurs. You likely don't want to be reading these during an actual incident.

- > [What is an Incident? \[before/what_is_an_incident/\]](#) - *Before we can talk about incident response, we need to define what an incident actually is.*
- > [Severity Levels \[before/severity_levels/\]](#) - *Information on our severity level classification. What constitutes a SEV-3 vs SEV-1? What response do they get?*
- > [Different Roles for Incidents \[before/different_roles/\]](#) - *Information on the roles during an incident(i.e. Incident Commander (IC), Scribe, etc.)*

- › [Incident Call Etiquette \[before/call_etiquette/\]](#) - *Our etiquette guidelines for incident calls (before you find yourself in one).*
- › [Complex Incidents \[before/complex_incidents/\]](#) - *Our guide for handling larger, more complex incidents.*

During an Incident

Information and processes during a major incident.

- › [During an Incident \[during/during_an_incident/\]](#) - *Information on what to do during an incident and how to constructively contribute.*
- › [Security Incident Response \[during/security_incident_response/\]](#) - *Security incidents are handled differently than normal operational incidents.*

After an Incident

Our followup-processes, how we make sure we don't repeat mistakes, and are always improving.

- › [After an Incident \[after/after_an_incident/\]](#) - *Information on what to do after an incident is resolved.*
- › [Postmortem Process \[after/post_mortem_process/\]](#) - *Information on our postmortem process, what's involved, and how to write or run a postmortem.*
- › [Postmortem Template \[after/post_mortem_template/\]](#) - *The template we use for writing our postmortems for major incidents.*
- › [Effective Postmortems \[after/effective_post_mortems/\]](#) - *A guide for writing effective postmortems.*

Crisis Response

Incident response is about more than dealing with technical incidents. A crisis can happen at any time. Are you ready for it? The way you handle your worst day will leave lasting impressions about your brand and its perceived value in the eyes of your current and potential customers.

- › [Introduction \[crisis/crisis_intro/\]](#) - *An introduction to crisis response and who this document is intended for.*
- › [Terminology \[crisis/terms/\]](#) - *A list of key terms and concepts used in this guide.*

- › [Crisis Leadership \[crisis/leadership/\]](#) - *Incorporating basic principles and your values in your response.*
- › [Crisis Response Operations \[crisis/operations/\]](#) - *Activating your crisis response plans.*
- › [Pre-crisis Phase \[crisis/prework/\]](#) - *Capitalizing on preparedness activities to keep your teams ready and engaged.*
- › [PagerDuty for CRM Ops \[crisis/pagerduty/\]](#) - *How PagerDuty leverages PagerDuty for crisis response management operations.*

Training

So you want to learn about incident response? You've come to the right place.

- › [Training Overview \[training/overview/\]](#) - *An overview of our training guides and additional training material from third parties.*
- › [Glossary of Incident Response Terms \[training/glossary/\]](#) - *A collection of terms that you may hear being used along with their definitions.*

Training Guides

- › [Incident Commander Training \[training/incident_commander/\]](#) - *A guide to becoming an Incident Commander.*
- › [Deputy Training \[training/deputy/\]](#) - *How to be a Deputy and back up the Incident Commander.*
- › [Scribe Training \[training/scribe/\]](#) - *A guide to Scribing.*
- › [Subject Matter Expert Training \[training/subject_matter_expert/\]](#) - *A guide on responsibilities and behavior for all participants in a major incident.*
- › [Customer Liaison Training \[training/customer_liaison/\]](#) - *A guide on how to act as our public representative during an incident.*
- › [Internal Liaison Training \[training/internal_liaison/\]](#) - *A guide on how to liaise with internal teams during an incident.*

Training Courses

- › [Incident Response Training Course \[training/courses/incident_response/\]](#) - *An introductory course on incident response and the role of the Incident Commander (IC).*

Additional Resources

Useful material and resources from external parties that are relevant to incident response.

- › [Reading \[resources/reading/\]](#) - *Recommended reading material relevant to incident response.*
- › [ChatOps \[resources/chatops/\]](#) - *Description of the chat bot commands we've referenced in this documentation.*
- › [Anti-Patterns \[resources/anti_patterns/\]](#) - *List of things we've tried and then rejected - learn from our mistakes.*